How a legal case moves

Como um caso legal avança, passo a passo

In the US, a person is innocent until proven guilty. Each step below is a different thing, and many stories stop at the first ones.

Presunção de inocência: ninguém é culpado até um tribunal provar.

1 Someone makes a claim

Alguém faz uma afirmação

IN THIS STORY

A news report, a company or an official says that something happened. At this point it is only an allegation: nobody has proved it.

> *The New York Times reported that US officials had been looking into Huang's relationship with Alice Huang. China and Megaspeed deny wrongdoing.*

allegation
alegação, afirmação ainda sem prova

alleged
suposto

deny
negar

wrongdoing
conduta errada ou ilegal

2 People look into it

Investigação

IN THIS STORY

A company can investigate itself, often with outside lawyers. Government agencies can investigate too. Investigators collect evidence: documents, messages, interviews.

> *Nvidia's board opened an independent investigation. It says it has no reason to believe that secrets were compromised.*

look into
investigar, examinar (informal)

investigate
investigar

suspect
suspeitar (verbo); suspeito (substantivo)

evidence
evidências, provas

3 Questions in public

Perguntas em público

REQUESTED FOR NOV 18

Congress can ask a person to come to a hearing and answer questions. If the person refuses, Congress can use a subpoena, which is a legal order. A hearing is not a trial: nobody is found guilty or innocent there.

> *Three Republican House chairmen asked Huang to appear on November 18.*

hearing
audiência

appear before
comparecer diante de

testify
depor, testemunhar

subpoena
intimação: ordem legal para depor ou entregar documentos

4 Prosecutors decide on charges

A acusação formal

NO CHARGES REPORTED

If prosecutors think they have enough evidence of a crime, they bring charges: a formal accusation. For serious federal crimes, a grand jury usually has to approve them first. If the evidence is not enough, no charges are filed and the case stops.

> *No charges have been reported against anyone in this story.*

charges
acusações formais na Justiça

file charges / bring charges
apresentar acusação formal (quem faz isso é o promotor)

press charges
informal: denunciar alguém e pedir que haja um processo. Nos EUA, quem decide é o promotor, não a vítima

be charged with
ser formalmente acusado de

indictment
acusação formal aprovada por um grande júri

grand jury
grupo de cidadãos que decide se há base para acusar

5 Plea or trial

Defesa e julgamento

The accused person is the defendant. He or she can plead guilty or not guilty. Many cases end with a plea deal. If not, there is a trial, with a judge or a jury.

defendant
réu

plead guilty / not guilty
declarar-se culpado / inocente

plea deal
acordo: o réu admite o crime em troca de uma pena menor

trial
julgamento

jury
júri, cidadãos que decidem o caso

6 Verdict and after

Veredicto e depois

The jury or the judge gives a verdict. A person who is convicted gets a sentence. The person can appeal to a higher court.

verdict
veredicto, decisão final do julgamento

convicted / acquitted
condenado / absolvido

sentence
pena, castigo decidido pelo juiz

appeal
recorrer; recurso a um tribunal superior

Another road: a civil lawsuit

Outro caminho: processo civil

A PROPOSED LAWSUIT

A lawsuit is a civil case. One side, the plaintiff, sues the other side and asks a court for money or for a change. Nobody goes to prison in a civil case. Many lawsuits end in a settlement, an agreement made before the court decides.

> *A proposed shareholder lawsuit says that investors were misled. It is a claim; it has not been decided.*

lawsuit
processo judicial (civil)

sue
processar

plaintiff
autor da ação

shareholder
acionista

settle / settlement
fazer acordo / acordo que encerra o processo

Target or culprit?

Alvo ou culpado?

A target is a person that someone tries to use or watch. A target can be completely innocent. A culprit is the person who did the wrong thing.

> *Nvidia's board says it is looking into reports that Huang was the target of a foreign intelligence effort. That is not the same as saying he spied.*

Secrets or chips?

Segredos ou chips? Duas suspeitas diferentes

Two different suspicions. Neither one has been proved.

Secrets Espionagem	**Chips** Controle de exportação
THE QUESTION A pergunta	
Did information from Nvidia reach people linked to China?	Did banned chips reach China through Megaspeed?
WHAT IS AT STAKE O que está em jogo	
Information: plans, customers, decisions.	Products: advanced AI chips.
WHO IS LOOKING Quem investiga	
Nvidia's board. Congress asked Huang for a briefing.	US authorities and Singapore, mainly about Megaspeed.
PROVED? Provado?	
No. The board says it has no reason to believe secrets were compromised.	No. Nvidia says it found no evidence of diversion.

Which chips are restricted?

Quais chips são restritos? Situação em 2026; as regras mudam

Restricted means the chip may not be sold to China without permission. It can legally be sold to other countries.

Blackwell, and the coming Rubin — **NOT ALLOWED**
The most powerful chips. Still barred for China.
Os mais potentes. Continuam barrados.

H100 — **NOT ALLOWED**
Barred for China since late 2022.
Barrado desde o fim de 2022.

H200 — **CASE BY CASE**
Needs a US license since January 2026. The US takes 25% of sales.
Exige licença desde janeiro de 2026.

H20 — **ALLOWED**
Made to fit under the limit. It was stopped for a while, then allowed again.
Feito para ficar abaixo do limite.

> *The suspicion about Megaspeed is that chips sold elsewhere were used remotely by customers in China. That has not been proved.*

Words about secrets

Palavras sobre segredos e vazamentos

secret / trade secret
segredo / segredo industrial
A trade secret is information that gives a company an advantage, like a recipe or a design.

confidential
confidencial
The contract is confidential. Do not share it.

sensitive information
informação sensível, que pode causar dano se sair
Passwords are sensitive information.

classified
classificado, segredo oficial de governo
The report is classified, so only a few officials can read it.

reveal / disclose
revelar, divulgar
A company must disclose serious risks to its investors.

leak
vazar; vazamento
Someone leaked the memo to a reporter.

pass on / hand over
repassar, entregar
She passed on the files to a competitor.

spy / espionage
espião, espionar / espionagem
Spying between companies is called industrial espionage.

intelligence
serviço secreto; informação coletada sobre outros países
The intelligence agency collects information about other countries.

compromise
comprometer: expor um segredo a quem não deve
A lost phone can compromise company data.

expose (to risk)
expor a risco
Sharing the password exposed the team to risk.

NDA (non-disclosure agreement)
acordo de confidencialidade
Employees sign an NDA before they see new products.

off the record
em off, não para publicar
He spoke off the record, so the reporter cannot use his name.

Words about chips and exports

Palavras sobre chips e exportação

export controls
controles de exportação: leis que limitam o que se pode vender a outros países
Export controls limit which chips a company can sell to China.

banned / restricted
proibido / restrito: só com autorização
The chip is restricted, so the seller needs permission.

license
licença: autorização do governo para vender
The company applied for a license to export the chips.

case by case
caso a caso
Officials review each request case by case.

loophole
brecha na lei
Remote access can be a loophole in the rules.

divert / diversion
desviar / desvio: mandar para um destino não autorizado
Investigators look for chips that were diverted.

smuggle / smuggling
contrabandear / contrabando
Smuggling chips can lead to criminal charges.

comply with
cumprir uma regra ou lei
The company says it complies with the law.

end user
usuário final, quem realmente usa o produto
A seller must know who the end user is.

A simplified picture of the US system. Rules change by country and by case. This is language help, not legal advice. Online: the Legalese tab and the practice page of the Clipping.